Halloween

By Jerry Seinfeld

INTRODUCTION

I'll trade you ALL my tootsie rolls for 3 of your Snickers! Yup . . . that's when we first learned to barter! But that's not all we learned on . . . Halloween by Jerry Seinfeld.

JERRY: When you're a kid you can eat amazing amounts of food. All I ate when I was a kid was candy. Just candy, candy, candy. And the only really clear thought I had as a kid was ***get candy***. Get candy, Get Candy, **Get Candy, GET CANDY.**

Family, friends, school – they were just obstacles in the way of getting more candy.

So the first time you hear the concept of Halloween when you are a kid, you're brain can't even process the idea.

You're like, "What is this? What did you say? Someone's giving out candy? Who's giving out candy? **EVERYONE WE KNOW IS JUST GIVING OUT CANDY?"**

"I gotta be a part of this. Take me with you! I'll do anything they want . . . **I can wear that.** I'll wear anything I have to wear. I'll do anything I have to do to get the candy from those **fools** who are so stupidly **giving it away**."

The first couple of years I made my own costumes. Ghost, hobo . . . the worst.

I knew my destiny was to one day get a **real** Superman Halloween costume from the store. You know the one . . . The cardboard box . . . the cellophane top, mask included in the set . . . **OH, BABY**!

Remember the rubber band on the back of those masks? That was a quality item. Thinnest gray rubber in the world. It was good for about ten seconds before it snapped out of that cheap little staple they put it in there with.

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You go to the first house, "Trick or . . ." **SNAP**! It broke, I don't believe it! "Wait up! I got to fix it. You guys, wait up!" Kids don't want other kids to wait, they want them to wait **UP**. Would you **wait up**?

Because when you're little, your whole life is up. You want to grow up. Everything is up!

"Wait **UP**!"
"Hold **UP**!"
"**Shut UP**!"
"Mom, I'll clean **UP** . . .
Just let me stay **UP**!"

When you're a parent, it's just the opposite: Everything is down.

"Just calm down!"
"Slow **DOWN**!"
"Sit **DOWN**!"
"Come **DOWN** here!"
"Put that **DOWN**!"
"And keep it **DOWN** in there!
"You're **GROUNDED**!"

So the day finally came. I finally convinced my parents to buy me an official **Superman** Halloween-store costume. I was physically ready. I was mentally prepared. And I absolutely believed when I put this costume on that I would look ***exactly*** like the **Superman** I had come to know on television and in the movies.

Unfortunately, these costumes are not exactly the **super fit** that you are hoping for. You look more like you are wearing Superman's pajamas. It's all loose and flowy. The **neckline** comes down to about your stomach. You got that **flimsy** little ribbon string in the back holding it all together.

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Plus, my mother makes me wear my **winter coat** over the costume anyway. I don't recall Superman wearing a **jacket**. I read every comic book. I do not remember him ever once flying with a coat on. Not like the one I had – cheap corduroy, phone fur.

So you go out anyway and the mask keeps breaking, the rubber band keeps getting shorter because you need to keep **re-tying it.** It's getting tighter and tighter on your face. Now you can't even **see**!

You're trying to breathe through that little hole that gets all sweaty. ***Whoosh, whoosh.*** The mask starts slicing into your eyeballs. **"I can't see, I can't breathe. But let's keep going. We gotta get the candy!"**

About half an hour into trick-or-treating you take that mask off. "Oh, the heck with it!"

Bing-Bong. "Yeah, it's me, give me the candy. I'm Superman, look at the red pant legs."

Year after year, I never gave up on trick-or-treating. But I remember those **last**, few Halloweens.

I was getting a little too old for it . . . I was just kinda going through the motions.

Bing-Bong. "Come on lady, let's go! Halloween, doorbells, candy, let's pick it up in there."

They come to the door; they always ask you the same stupid question. "What are **you** supposed to be?"

"I'm supposed to be **done** by now. You want to move it along with the 3Musketeers? I got eighteen houses on this block, sweetheart. **You hit the bad, we hit the road.** That's the way it works."

Halloween 3-Step Program:

- Step 1: See kid.
- Step 2: Give candy.
- Step 3: Good night.

Sometimes people give you the little white bag, twisted on the top. You know that's gonna be some **crummy** candy. "No **official Halloween** markings on it? **I don't think so.**"

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"Wait a second, what is this? The orange marshmallow shaped like a big peanut?

"Do me a favor, you keep that one. We've got all the doorstops we need already, thank you very much. We're going for **name candy** only this year."

At the end of **Halloween** I was able to fill a punch bowl so full of candy that the top of it would be curved. It was like a **planet**. And I would consume the **ENTIRE THING** that night.

Next morning, I'd wake up, feel **fantastic**. And that's when I realized, when you're a kid you don't need a costume, you ***are*** Superman.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Jerry Seinfeld
ISBN: 978-0316706254
Publisher: Little, Brown and Company
Date (Month/Year): Sept 2002

AWARD HISTORY

2016 National Qualifier – MS
2019 National Qualifier – MS
KDS State Qualifier

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